

Abnormal Psychology

MS. AQSA FAYYAZ
LECTURER (PSYCHOLOGY)
SCIENCE AND HUMANITIES



Learning Outcomes

Distinguish between normal and abnormal behaviors

Learn about mental disorders

Learn about various treatment approaches for psychological disorders



Mental Health

According to World Health Organization (WHO):

“Mental Health is a state of well-being in which an individual realizes his or her own abilities, can cope with the normal stresses of life, can work productively, and is able to make a contribution to his or her community”



Abnormal Psychology

“Branch of psychology deals with the abnormal / pathological mental processes and behaviors”



Normal and Abnormal Behaviors

**How can we distinguish
normal from abnormal
behavior?**

Identifying Abnormality 4-Ds

Deviation from Social Norms



Highly unusual behaviors that stray far from the norms.

Example: Hearing voices

Abnormality as a Sense of Personal Discomfort (Distress)



Behavior is considered abnormal if it produces a sense of personal distress, anxiety, or guilt in an individual—or if it is harmful to others in some way.

Example: Obsessive Compulsive Disorder

Abnormality as Dysfunction



Disability or an impairment in some important areas of life (work or in personal relationship).

Example: Impact of Substance Use Disorders

Abnormality as Danger



Behaviors and feelings that cause interference with life and pose risk of harm.

Example: Paranoid ideation

Factors contributing to mental disorders

Biological

- Neurochemicals, neurotransmitters, hormones, brain, nervous system etc.

Psychological

- Cognitions, emotions, personality, coping styles, resilience, values, etc.

Social

- Social support, family relations, friends, interpersonal factors, love, affiliation etc.

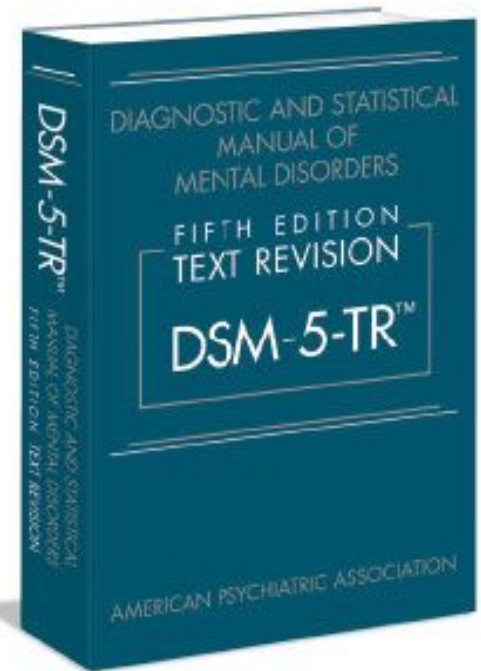
Diagnostic Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders

The big book of disorders.

Published by the American Psychiatric Association

DSM classifies disorders and describe the symptoms.

Does NOT explain the possible cures.



Two Major Classifications of Mental Disorders

Neurotic Disorders

- Distressing but one can still function in society and act rationally.

Psychotic Disorders

- Person loses contact with reality, experiences distorted perceptions.



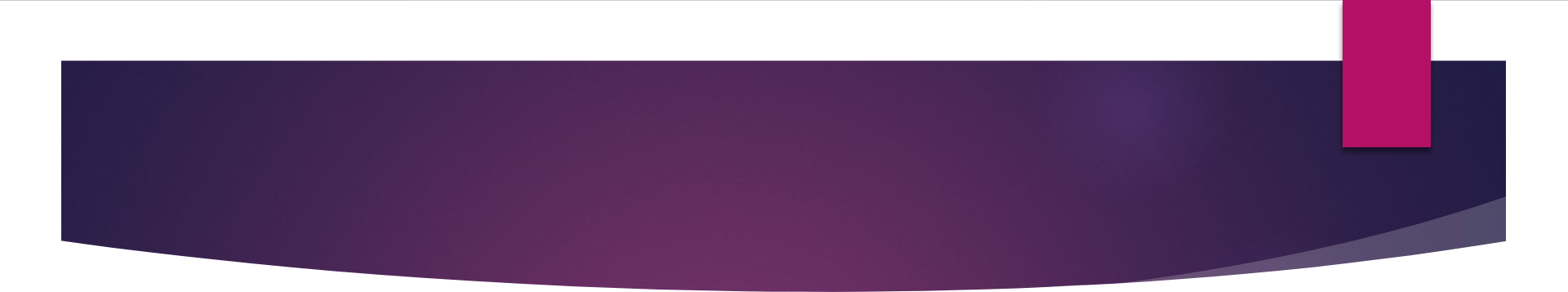
Psychotic Disorders

- Schizophrenia
- Brief Psychotic Disorder
- Delusional Disorder
- Substance-induced Psychotic Disorder



Neurotic Disorders

- Generalized Anxiety Disorder
- Depression
- Obsessive-compulsive Disorder
- Social Phobia
- Posttraumatic Stress Disorder
- Panic Disorder
- Antisocial Personality Disorder



COMMON PSYCHOLOGICAL DISORDERS





Mental Disorders

According to DSM 5

"A mental disorder is a syndrome characterized by **clinically significant disturbance** in an individual's cognition, emotion, regulation or behavior that reflects a **dysfunction** in the psychological, biological, or developmental processes underlying mental functioning.

Mental disorders are usually associated with significant distress or disability in **social, occupational or other important activities**"

Mental Health Disorders

Depression

Panic Disorder

Schizophrenia

Obsessive
Compulsive
Disorder

Bipolar

Caffeine Use
Disorder

Internet
Gaming
Disorder

Major Depressive Disorder



Major Depressive Disorder



Major Depressive Disorder (also known as depression) is a common mood disorder. It involves a **depressed mood or loss of pleasure or interest in activities for long periods of time (persistent)**.

People with Major Depressive Disorder experience low mood most of the day, nearly every day or loss of interest or pleasure in all or almost all activities for at least 2 weeks.



Sleep disturbance

Significant weight loss/weight gain. Changes in appetite

Fatigue or loss of energy. Even small tasks take extra effort.

Feelings of excessive guilt or low self-worth

Hopelessness about the future

Poor concentration or indecisiveness

Thoughts about dying or suicide

Clinically significant distress or impairment in social, occupational or other important areas of functioning.



Panic Disorder



Panic Disorder

anxiety disorder where you regularly have sudden attacks of panic or fear.

Panic attacks (a sudden episode of intense fear) occur that last from a few seconds to several minutes.

These frequent and unexpected panic attacks are characterized by a sudden wave of fear or discomfort or a sense of losing control even when there is no clear danger or trigger.



PANIC ATTACK SYMPTOMS



Dizziness



Breathing difficulties



Chest pain



Nausea & Vomiting



Body tremors



Sweating



Pounding heart

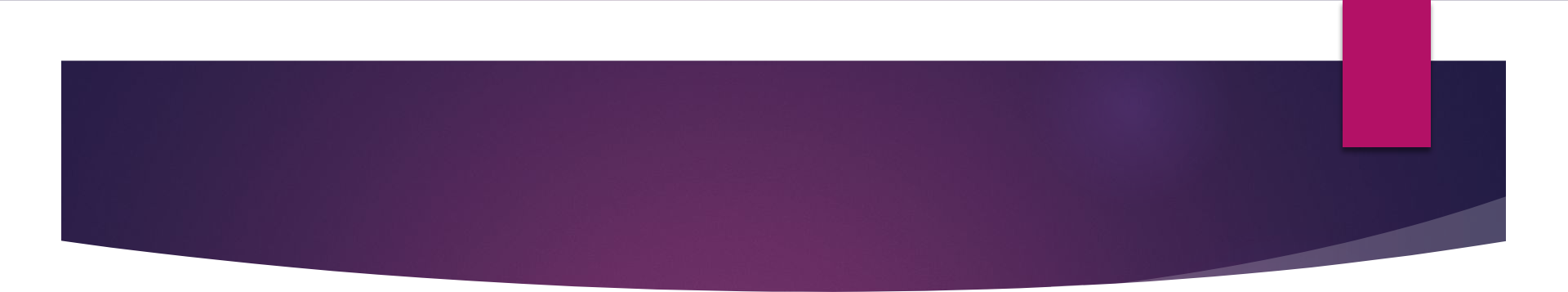


Fear

People with panic disorder may have:

- Sudden and repeated panic attacks of overwhelming anxiety and fear
- Panic attacks often include physical symptoms that might feel like a heart attack, such as trembling, tingling, or rapid heart rate.
- People with panic disorder think that they're losing control, having a heart attack or even dying. During an attack, anxiety rises to a peak, and an individual feels a sense of impending, unavoidable doom.



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- An intense worry about when the next panic attack will happen. Many people with panic disorder worry about the possibility of having another attack and may significantly change their life to avoid having another attack. Panic attacks can occur at any time.
 - A fear or avoidance of places where panic attacks have occurred in the past.
 - Unlike phobias, which are stimulated by specific objects or situations, panic disorders do not have any identifiable stimuli
 - Not everyone who experiences a panic attack will develop panic disorder.

Schizophrenia



Schizophrenia

A serious mental illness that affects how a person thinks, feels, and behaves.

People with schizophrenia may seem like they have lost touch with reality, which can be distressing for them and for their family and friends. Severe distortion of reality occurs.



Schizophrenia may result in some combination of hallucinations, delusions, and extremely disordered thinking and behavior that impairs daily functioning, and can be disabling.

Thinking, perception, and emotion may deteriorate; the individual may withdraw from social interaction; and the person may display bizarre behavior.



OBSSESSIVE-COMPLUSIVE DISORDER



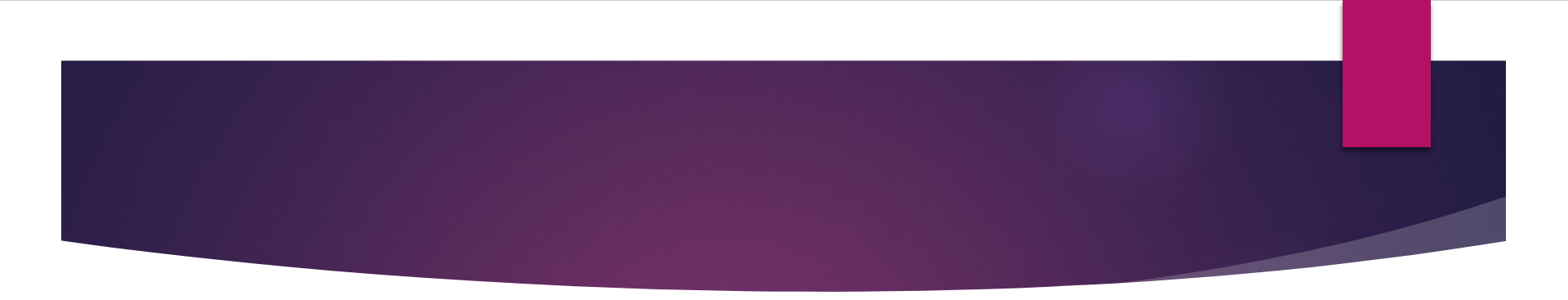


A disorder in which people have recurring, unwanted thoughts, ideas or sensations (obsessions). To get rid of the thoughts, they feel driven to do something repetitively (compulsions).

An obsession is a persistent, unwanted thought, idea or image that keeps recurring.

People experience compulsions, irresistible urges to repeatedly carry out some act that seems strange and unreasonable even to them. Whatever the compulsive behavior is, people experience extreme anxiety if they cannot carry it out even if it is something they want to stop.

Examples: Repeatedly checking the stove if its turned off, excessive hand washing, counting, repeating words silently, or rituals. The repetitive behaviors can significantly interfere with a person's daily activities and social interactions.



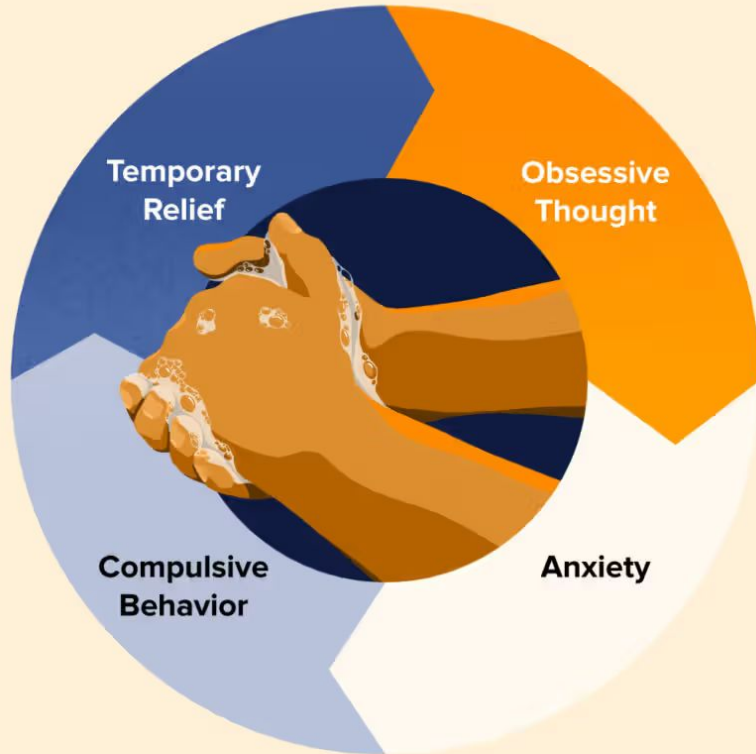
For people with OCD, thoughts are persistent and intrusive, and behaviors are rigid. Not performing the behaviors commonly causes great distress, often attached to a specific fear of dire consequences (to self or loved ones) if the behaviors are not completed.

Many people with OCD know or suspect their obsessional thoughts are not realistic; others may think they could be true. Even if they know their obsessional thoughts are not realistic, people with OCD have difficulty disengaging from the obsessive thoughts or stopping the compulsive actions.

A diagnosis of OCD requires the presence of obsessional thoughts and/or compulsions that are time-consuming (more than one hour a day), cause significant distress, and impair work or social functioning.

Some people may have some symptoms of OCD but not meet full criteria for this disorder.

The OCD Cycle



Bipolar Disorder



Bipolar Disorder

A group of mood disorders that cause extreme fluctuation in a person's mood, energy, and ability to function.

People who live with bipolar disorder experience periods of great excitement, over activity, delusions, and euphoria (known as mania) and other periods of feeling sad and hopeless (known as depression).

These emotional states typically occur during distinct periods of days to weeks, called mood episodes. These mood episodes are categorized as manic/hypomanic (abnormally happy or irritable mood) or depressive (sad mood) - **Emotional highs (mania or hypomania) and lows (depression)**

These mood swings can affect sleep, energy, activity, judgment, behavior and the ability to think clearly.



Internet Gaming Disorder



Internet Gaming Disorder

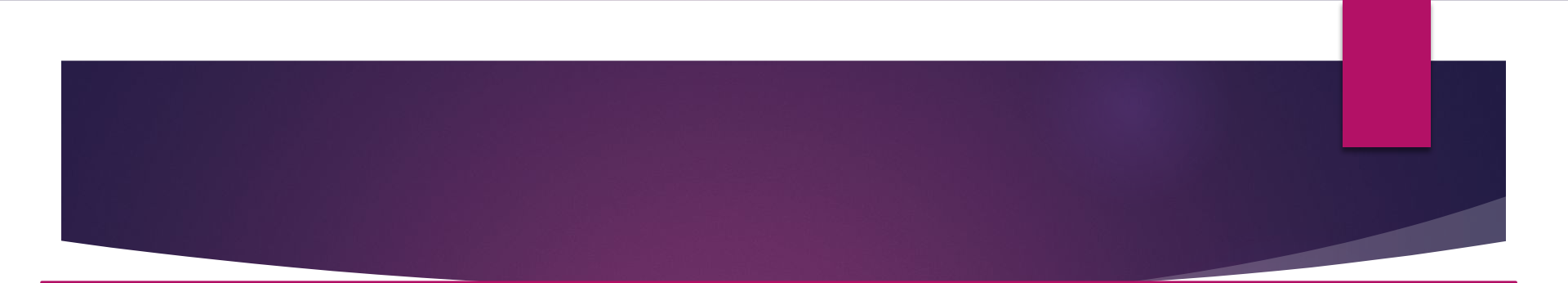
Early evidence suggests that videogames are one of the most addicting technologies around.

Addiction to gaming is described in the American Psychiatric Association's *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (DSM-5-TR)*,

In the *DSM-5-TR*, the condition is referred to as Internet Gaming Disorder (IGD). IGD is included in the section recommending conditions for further research, along with caffeine use disorder and other conditions.

DSM-5-TR notes that IGD must cause "significant impairment or distress" in several aspects of a person's life. This proposed condition is limited to gaming and does not include problems with general use of the internet, online gambling, or use of social media or smartphones. The proposed symptoms of internet gaming disorder include:





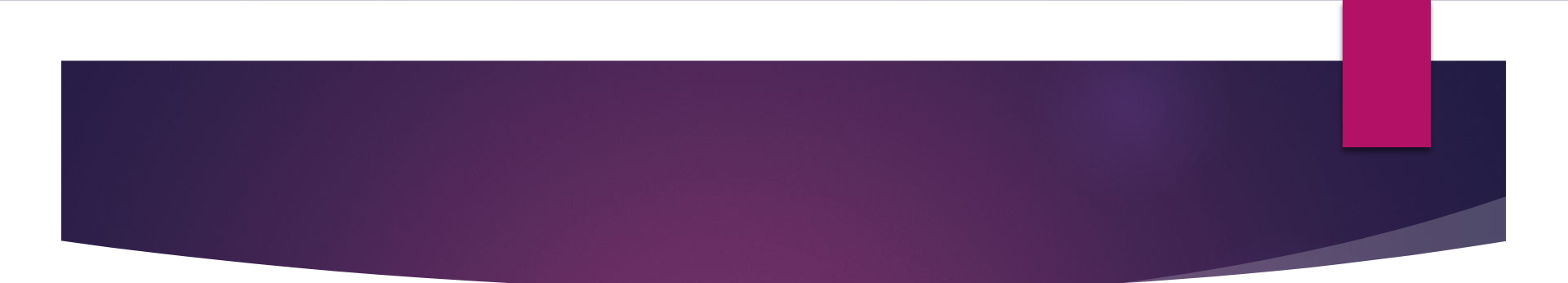
Preoccupation with gaming

Withdrawal symptoms when gaming is taken away or not possible
(sadness, anxiety, irritability)

Tolerance, the need to spend more time gaming to satisfy the urge

Inability to reduce playing, unsuccessful attempts to quit gaming

Giving up other activities, loss of interest in previously enjoyed activities
due to gaming



Continuing to game despite problems

Deceiving family members or others about the amount of time spent on gaming
The use of gaming to relieve negative moods, such as guilt or hopelessness

Risk, lost a job or relationship due to gaming

Under the proposed criteria, a diagnosis of internet gaming disorder would require experiencing five or more of these symptoms within a year. The condition can include gaming on the internet with others or alone.

Caffeine Use Disorder



Caffeine Use Disorder

Caffeine Intoxication and Withdrawal

Caffeine intoxication and caffeine withdrawal are included in *DSM-5*. Caffeine use disorder, however, is in the section of *DSM-5* for conditions requiring further research. While there is evidence to support this as a disorder, experts conclude it is not yet clear to what extent it is a clinically significant disorder.



Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)



Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)

A neurodevelopmental disorder

Persistent symptoms of inattention and/or hyperactivity and impulsivity that interfere with functioning or development.

- People with ADHD experience an ongoing pattern of:
- **INATTENTION:** Having problems staying on task, paying attention, or being organized, which are not due to defiance or a lack of comprehension.



Easily distracted



Difficulty focusing



Forgetfulness



Always remain worried



Easily get irritated

Attention-deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD)

•**HYPERACTIVITY:** Being extremely restless or constantly moving, including in situations when it is not appropriate; excessively fidgeting or tapping; or talking too much.

•**IMPULSIVITY:** Acting without thinking, interrupting others, or having difficulty with self-control. Impulsivity can also involve a desire for immediate rewards or an inability to delay gratification or consider long-term consequences.



Easily distracted



Difficulty focusing



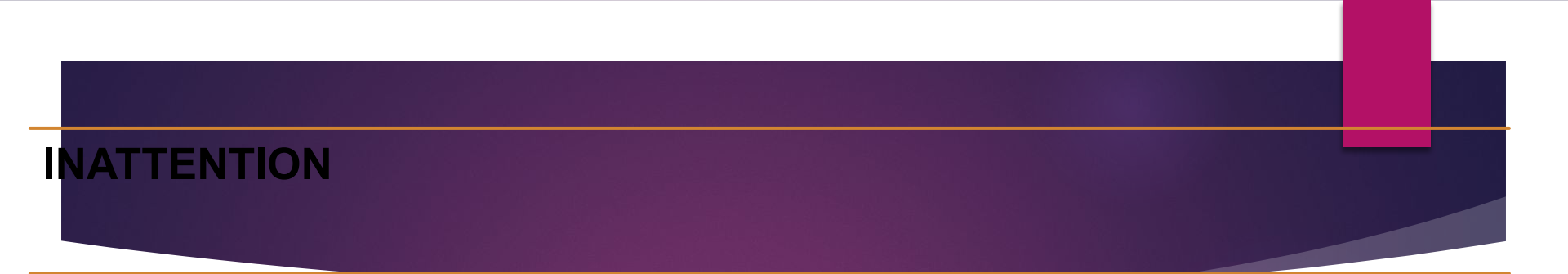
Forgetfulness



Always remain worried



Easily get irritated

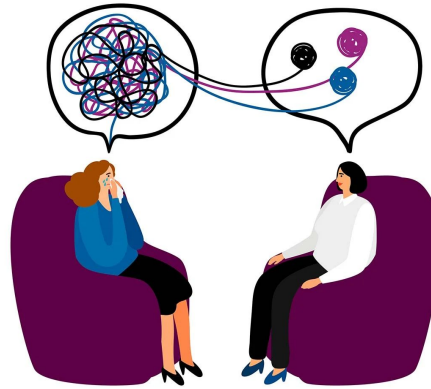


INATTENTION

Difficulty Sustaining Attention: Struggles to remain focused during lectures, conversations, or reading.

- Poor Listening Skills: Appears not to listen when spoken to directly, with the mind wandering.
- Failure to Follow Instructions: Frequently does not follow through on instructions, leading to incomplete tasks.
- Organizational Challenges: Difficulty organizing tasks, managing sequential activities, or keeping belongings in order.

Treatment of Psychological Disorders



Treatment depends on the type of mental illness its severity and what works best.

In many cases, **a combination of treatments works best.**

Treatments

1. The **psychological approach** to reducing disorder involves providing help to individuals or families through psychological therapy, including **psychoanalysis, humanistic-oriented therapy, cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)**, and other approaches.

2. The **biomedical approach to reducing disorder** is based on the use of medications to treat mental disorders such as schizophrenia, depression, and anxiety, as well as the employment of brain intervention techniques, including **electroconvulsive therapy (ECT), transcranial magnetic stimulation (TMS), and psychosurgery**.

3. The **social approach to reducing disorder** focuses on changing the social environment in which individuals live to reduce the underlying causes of disorder.

These approaches include **group, couple, and family therapy**, as well as **community outreach programs**.

The community approach is likely to be the most effective of the three approaches because it focuses not only on treatment, but also on prevention of disorders (World Health Organization, 2004).

